

Russell Dudek

OPERATOR-TECHNOLOGIST · AI DEPLOYMENT & OPERATING TRANSFORMATION

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Go-live is a date.
Value is an operating state.

Operator-technologist who makes complex work visible, connects technical and business teams, and builds operating mechanisms that turn emerging technology into adopted, measurable outcomes.

DEPLOYMENT LENS

Outcome definition

Technical readiness

Adoption & enablement

Evidence & evaluation

Decision ownership

Post-launch learning

Comfortable translating among executives, customers, operators, engineers, data, and delivery teams.

WAYS OF WORKING

Customer-backward

Consultative delivery

Lean / Gemba

Human-in-the-loop

Root cause & standard work

Fast, visible escalation

CREDENTIALS

IBM Enterprise Design Thinking Practitioner

Six Sigma Certification

OSHA 10

RELEVANT LEADERSHIP EXPERIENCE

Director of Operations

2025–Present

VAPE-JET

- Lead AI-first operating transformation across production, purchasing, quality, customer success, support, engineering issue flow, ERP/Odoo, Jira, HubSpot, Slack, telemetry, and AI-assisted workflows.
- Connect factory, field, customer, and machine-fleet signals into prioritized work, earlier risk detection, cleaner handoffs, dashboards, standard work, training, and accountability.
- Operate in a software-enabled robotics and machine-vision environment with approximately 1,000 fielded robots informing support and operating feedback loops.

ADOPTION · TELEMETRY · CROSS-FUNCTIONAL OWNERSHIP

Founder / AI & Automation Advisor

2017–Present

DUDEWORTH

- Develop AI-readiness and opportunity frameworks that assess value, feasibility, data readiness, governance, adoption burden, reuse, and time-to-value.
- Design agentic workflow patterns using structured context, retrieval, AI agents, human judgment, escalation, decision records, evaluation, and governance rails.
- Advise on AI-enabled operations, logistics technology, automation, network analysis, and workflow design.

OUTCOME FRAMING · READINESS · HUMAN AUTHORITY

Operations Management / Site Leader

2014–2018

AMAZON

- Led launch and execution for Amazon Prime Pittsburgh in a 24/7 customer-backward environment supporting approximately five million second-day orders annually.
- Built leadership routines, labor planning, throughput visibility, escalation paths, standard work, and operating mechanisms.
- Applied Lean and Gemba practices across safety, quality, throughput, customer experience, and team engagement.

LAUNCH DISCIPLINE · OPERATING CADENCE · ESCALATION

Technical delivery depth.

Operating range.

EVIDENCE CONTINUED

Director of Operations & Engineering Management

2000–2013

COMPUNETICS

- Progressed through R&D program management, production management, strategic acquisition, operations management, and director-level leadership.
- Led engineering, manufacturing, quality, customer delivery, and complex technical programs in advanced electronics and high-reliability environments.
- Built quality systems, standard work, root-cause practices, performance measures, and process controls.
- Collaborated with high-consequence customers and partners including DoD, CERN, Intel, and AMD; published industry articles, delivered technical talks, and participated in the HyperTransport Consortium.

TECHNICAL TRANSLATION · PRODUCTION RIGOR · CUSTOMER DELIVERY

Regional Director

2021–2023

CARDINAL BUILDING PRODUCTS

- Built the company's first remote regional operation.
- Modernized distributed customer, CRM, commercial, fulfillment, logistics, digital marketing, SEO, and online-buying workflows.
- Advanced AI-enhanced transportation-management and route-planning concepts.

REMOTE OPERATIONS · WORKFLOW MODERNIZATION · COMMERCIAL HANDOFFS

Chief Pilot, Autonomous Systems & Aerial Data Operations

2018–2022

ZEUSVU

- Led regulated drone operations across medical, energy, logistics, real-estate, and restricted-airspace contexts with a 100% safety record and no FAA incidents.
- Developed TensorFlow-based concepts for automated aerial inventory and computer-vision-enabled field intelligence.
- Designed medical drone delivery and chain-of-custody concepts connecting technology, risk, stakeholders, and governed execution.

GOVERNED DEPLOYMENT · SAFETY · FIELD INTELLIGENCE

Chairman of the Board

2014–2017

ENVIRO SOCIAL CAPITAL

- Co-founded and led a public-private impact initiative focused on sustainable infrastructure, green finance, and civic transformation.
- Helped shape and evaluate a \$200 million Social Impact Bond feasibility concept for Pittsburgh sewage and green-infrastructure improvement.

EDUCATION

University of Pittsburgh

Bachelor of Science. Academic grounding includes materials science, physical chemistry, and biology-related studies.

TECHNICAL TOOLKIT

Agentic AI

LLM workflows

RAG patterns

Human-in-the-loop

Python

SQL

JavaScript

TensorFlow

Tableau

Odoo / ERP

Jira

Confluence

HubSpot

Slack

GIS

COMMUNITY LEADERSHIP

IEEE · CMPT & EDS Pittsburgh Chapter Chair

Led regional technology programming connecting industry, academia, STEM outreach, electronics, manufacturing, and emerging technology.

DEPLOYMENT STANCE

- Define the business decision.
- Surface readiness honestly.
- Design adoption into delivery.
- Instrument the outcome.
- Make ownership explicit.

CANDIDATE THESIS

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